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A Serious Game for Patients With Eating Disorders (Maze Out): Pilot User Experience and Acceptance Study

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Abstract

Background: Eating disorders (EDs) are severe mental disorders associated with notable impairments in the quality of life. Despite the severity of the disorders and extensive research in the field, effective treatment for EDs is lacking. Digital interventions are gaining an evidence-based position in

mental health, providing new perspectives in psychiatric treatment. Maze Out is a serious game coproduced by patients and therapists that focuses on supporting patients with EDs. Objective: The aim of this study was to investigate the experiences of engaging in and acceptability of Maze Out among patients

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Results: The participants found Maze Out to be engaging, easy to use, and a good platform for reflecting on their disorder. They primarily used Maze Out as a conversational tool with their close relationships, giving them insights into the experiences and daily life struggles of someone with EDs.

Conclusions: Maze Out seems to be a promising tool supplementing the current ED treatment. Further research should focus on evaluating the effectiveness of the game and its potential to support patients with different types of EDs.

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Keywords

- coproduction

- eating disorders
- mHealth
- mobile health
- mobile phone
- serious games

ASJC Scopus subject areas

- Medicine (miscellaneous)
- Health Informatics

UN SDGs

This output contributes to the following UN [Sustainable Development Goals \(SDGs\)](#)

- SDG 3 - Good Health and Well-being

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AU - Bul, Kim

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